

BREATH

"When I was almost six and Jem was nearly ten, our summertime boundaries (within calling distance of Calpurnia) were Mrs. Henry Lafayette Dubose's house two doors to the north of us, and the Radley Place three doors to the south. We were never tempted to break them. The Radley Place was inhabited by an unknown entity the mere description of whom was enough to make us behave for days on end; Mrs. Dubose was plain hell. That was the summer Dill came to town."

"Boo" was about six-and-a-half feet tall, judged from his tracks. He had a long, pointed snout, ears and an cat's mouth. That's why his hands were badly stained. "You ate an animal, and you could never wash the red off. There was a long, jagged scar that ran across his face; what teeth he had were yellow and rotten; his eyes popped, and he drooled most of the time."

"Miss Caroline seemed unaware that the ragged, denim-shirted and floursack-skirted grade, most of whom had chopped

cotton and fed hogs from the time they were able to walk, were immune to imaginative literature. Miss Caroline came to the end of the story and said, 'Oh, my, wasn't that nice?' Then she went to the blackboard and printed the alphabet in enormous square capitals, turned to the class and asked, 'Does anybody know what these are?'"

"Atticus was feeble," he was nearly fifty. When Jem and I asked him how he was so old, he said we got started late, which we felt reinforced upon his age and manliness. He was much older than the parents of our school contemporaries, and there was nothing Jem could say about him when our classmates

My father

"Neighbors bring food with death and flowers with sickness and little things in between. Boo was our neighbor. He gave us two soap dolls, a broken watch and chain, a pair of good-luck pennies, and our lives."

gotten to know the right people, and I've made some important connections. Connections are very important in this business. You'd be surprised how many people owe me favors."

He knew that when he kissed this girl, and
 never wed his unutterable visions to her
 fragile breath, his mind would never romp
 like that of God. So he waited,
 for a moment longer to the tuning-
 fork that had been struck upon a star. Then he
 kissed her. At his lips' touch, she blossomed
 for him like her sweet counterpart in the
 power and the incarnation was

...less people, Tom and Daisy —
up things and creatures and
back into their money or their
business, or whatever it was that kept
together, and let other people clean up
the mess they had made. . . . I shook hands
with him; it seemed silly not to, for I felt
as though I were talking to a child."

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...us was feeble: he was nearly fifty. When I asked him why he was so old, he said he had started late, which we felt was true in his abilities and manliness. He was older than the parents of our school children, and there was nothing remarkable about him when our classmates were young."

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sweet talcum. People moved slowly then. They ambled across the square, shuffled in and out of the stores around it, took their time about everything. A day was twenty-four hours long but seemed longer. There was no hurry, for there was nowhere to go, nothing to buy and no money to buy it with, nothing to see outside the boundaries of Maycomb County. But it was a time of vague optimism for some of the people: Maycomb County had recently been told that it had nothing to fear.

"Maycomb was an old town, but it was an old town when I first knew it. In rainy weather the streets turned to red slop; grass grew on the sidewalks, the courthouse sagged in the square. Somehow, it was hotter then: a black dog suffered on a summer's day; bony mules hitched to Hoover carts flicked flies in the sweltering shade of the live oaks on the square. Men's stiff collars wilted by nine in the morning. Ladies bathed before noon, after their three-o'clock naps, and by nightfall were like soft teacakes with frostings of sweat and sweet talcum. People moved slowly then. They ambled across the square, shuffled in and out of the stores around it, took their time about everything. A day was twenty-four hours long but seemed longer. There was no hurry, for there was nowhere to go, nothing to buy and no money to buy it with, nothing to see outside the boundaries of Maycomb County. But it was a time of vague optimism for some of the people: Maycomb County had recently been told that it had nothing to fear but fear itself."

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